the oxygen atoms. Thus, in oxygen molecule, two oxygen atoms are connected by two covalent bonds (double bond). The other two pair of electrons present in the 2s and $2p_x$ orbital do not involve in bonding and remains as lone pairs on the respective oxygen.

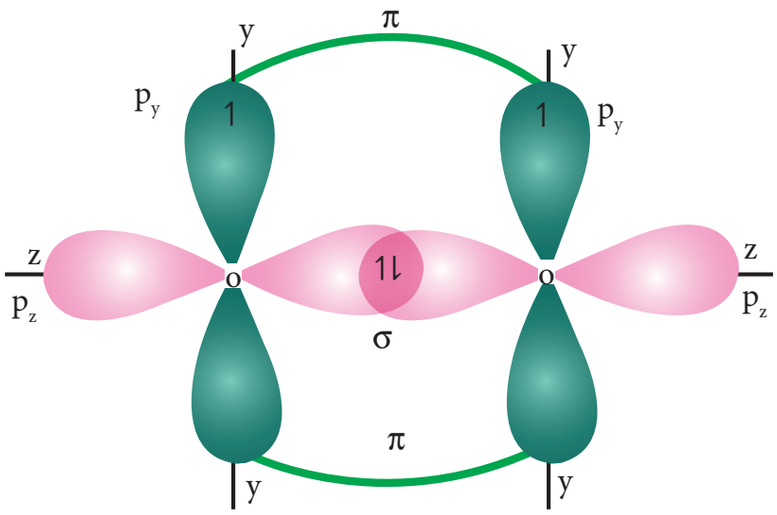


Fig 10. 21 Formation of π bond in O_2 Molecule

Evaluate Yourself

7) Bond angle in PH_4^+ is higher than in PH_3 why?

10.9 Hybridisation

Bonding in simple molecules such as hydrogen and fluorine can easily be explained on the basis of overlap of the respective atomic orbitals of the combining atoms. But the observed properties of polyatomic molecules such as methane, ammonia, beryllium chloride etc... cannot be explained on the basis of simple overlap of atomic orbitals. For example, it was experimentally proved that methane has a tetrahedral structure and the four C-H bonds are equivalent. This fact cannot be explained on the basis of overlap of atomic orbitals of hydrogen (1s) and the atomic orbitals of carbon with different energies ($2s^2\ 2p_x^2\ 2p_y 2p_z$).

In order to explain these observed facts, Linus Pauling proposed that the valence atomic orbitals in the molecules are different from those in isolated atom and he introduced the concept of hybridisation. Hybridisation is the process of mixing of atomic orbitals of the same atom with comparable energy to form equal number of new equivalent orbitals with same energy. The resultant orbitals are called hybridised orbitals and they posses maximum symmetry and definite orientation in space so as to minimize the force of repulsion between their electrons .

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